For Your Protection: Get a Home Inspection

BuyerName: _____
Property Address: _____

Why a Buyer Needs a Home Inspection

Ahome inspectiongives the buyer moredetailed information about the overall condition of the home prior to purchase. In a home inspection, a qualified inspector takes an in-depth, unbiased look at your potentialnew hometo:

1. Evaluate the physical condition: structure, construction, and mechanical systems;
2. Identify items that need to be repaired or replaced; and
3. Estimate the remaining useful life of the major systems, equipment, structure, and finishes.

Appraisals are Different from Home Inspections

An appraisalis differentfrom a home inspection.Appraisals are for lenders; home inspections are forbuyers. Anappraisalis required to:

1. Estimate the market value of a house;
2. Make sure that the house meets FHA minimum property standards/requirements and;
3. Make sure the house is marketable.

FHA Does Not Guarantee the Value or Condition of your Potential New Home

If you find problems with your new home after closing, FHA cannot give or lend you money for repairs, and FHA cannot buy the home back from you.

Radon Gas Testing

The United States Environmental Protection Agency and the Surgeon General of the United States have recommended that all houses should be tested for radon. For more information on radon testing, call the toll-free National Radon Information Line at 1-800-SOS-Radon, or 1-800-767-7236. As with a home inspection, if you decide to test for radon, you may do so before signing your contract, or you may do so after signing the contract as long as your contract states the sale of the home depends on your satisfaction with the results of the radon test.

Be an Informed Buyer

It is your responsibility to be an informed buyer. Be sure that what you buy is satisfactory in every respect. You have the right to carefully examine your potential new home with a qualified home inspector. You may arrange to do so before signing your contract, or may do so after signing the contract as long as your contract states that the sale of the home depends on the inspection.

I/We understand the importance of getting an independent home inspection. I/We have considered this before signing a contract with the seller for a home. Furthermore, I/We have carefully read this notice and fully understand that FHA will not perform a home inspection nor guarantee the price or condition of the property.

____ I/We choose to have a home inspection.

____ I/We choose NOT to have a home inspection.

Buyer: _____ Date: _____

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